

Ocean Animals Letter Matching Activity

Teacher Guidance

This resource is a hands-on, matching game designed to help early learners master alphabet recognition by pairing uppercase and lowercase letters. Featuring an engaging ocean animal theme, it is perfect for independent centers, small group intervention, or a whole-class warm-up during an ocean-themed unit.

Activity Overview

Each card features a friendly ocean animal split down the middle by a dashed line. The left side of the ocean animal displays an **uppercase letter**, and the right side displays the corresponding **lowercase letter**. Students will cut along the lines to separate the pieces and then work to reassemble the ocean animals by correctly matching the capital and lowercase pairs.

- **Target Grade Levels:** Preschool, Kindergarten
- **Core Skills:** Letter recognition, pairing uppercase and lowercase forms, and visual discrimination.

Instructions

1. **Print:** Print the document pages on heavy cardstock for durability.
2. **Laminate (Optional):** If you plan to reuse this resource in a classroom center, laminate the sheets before cutting.
3. **Cut:** First, cut along the outer thick dashed lines to separate the individual activity cards. Next, cut straight down the middle vertical line of each ocean animal card to separate the uppercase side from the lowercase side.
4. **Storage:** Store the puzzle pieces in a labeled ziplock bag, pencil pouch, or plastic bin.

How to Use in the Classroom

1. Independent Learning Center

Mix up the cut-up ocean animal pieces and place them in a center. Students work independently or in pairs to find the matching halves and build the complete ocean animals.

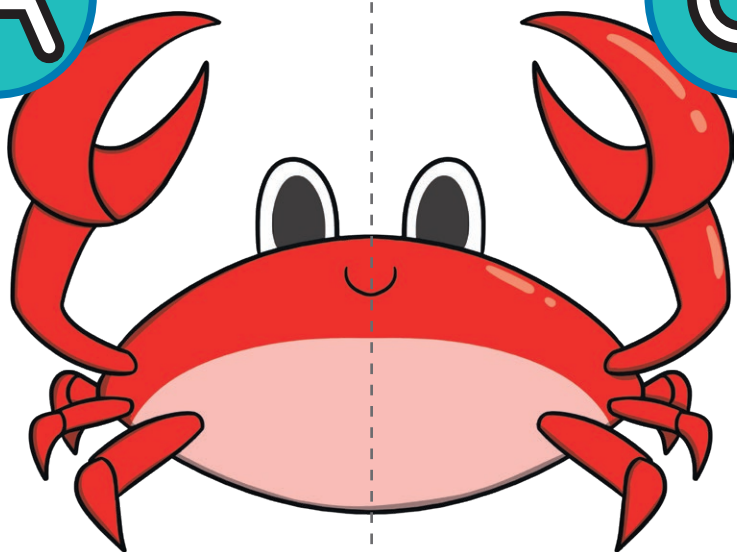
2. Differentiated Small Groups

To avoid overwhelming beginning learners, do not give them all 26 letters at once. Break the deck down based on student readiness:

- **Tier 1 (Support):** Introduce 3 to 5 matching pairs at a time, focusing on letters with highly distinct shapes (e.g., E and e).
- **Tier 2 (On Level):** Provide half of the alphabet at a time (e.g., letters A–M, then letters N–Z).
- **Tier 3 (Extension):** Give students the entire deck. Mix in visually tricky pairs like b/d or p/q to challenge and sharpen their visual discrimination skills.

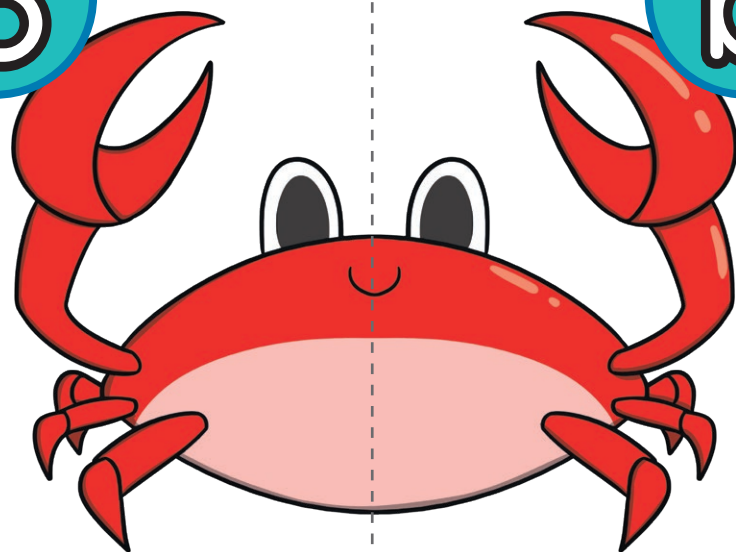
A

a



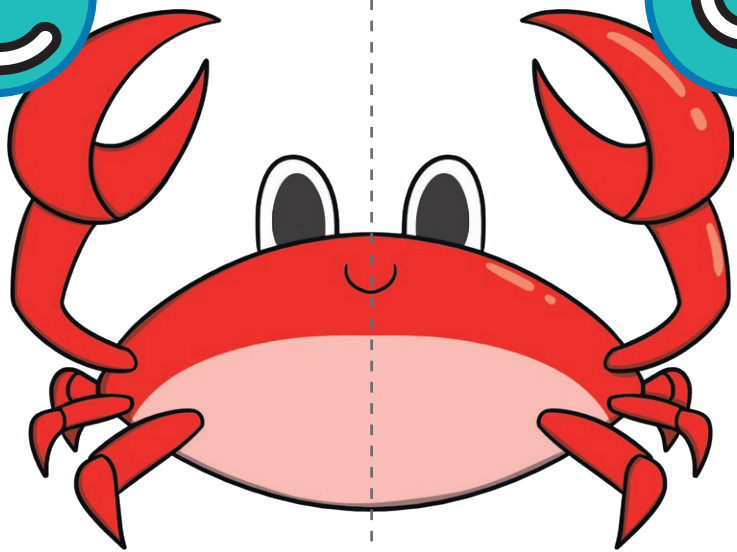
B

b



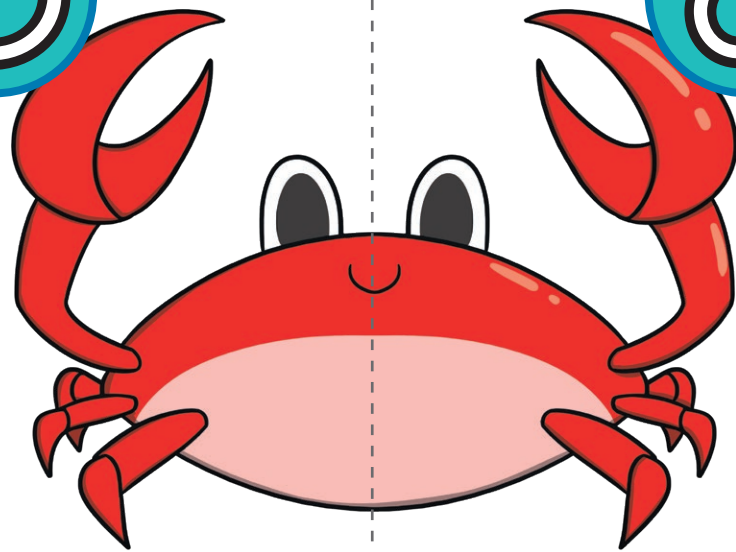
C

c

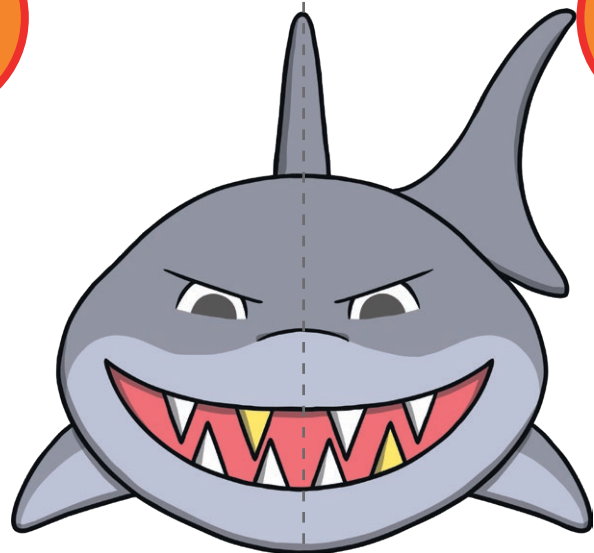


D

d

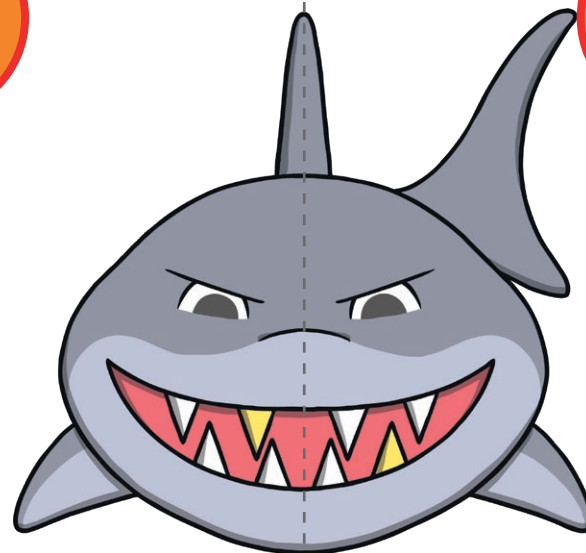


E



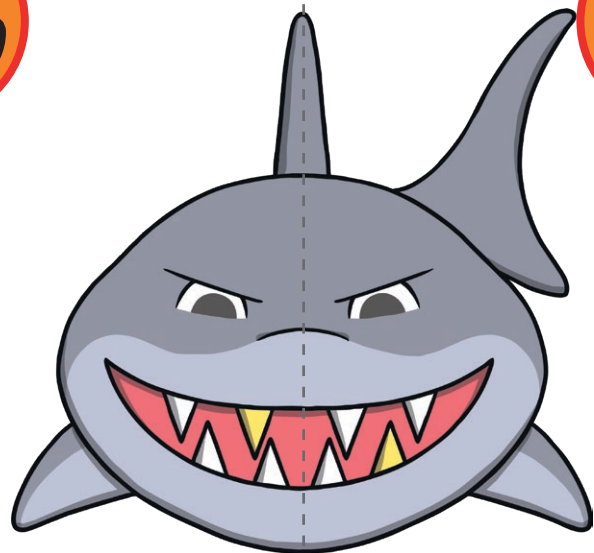
e

F



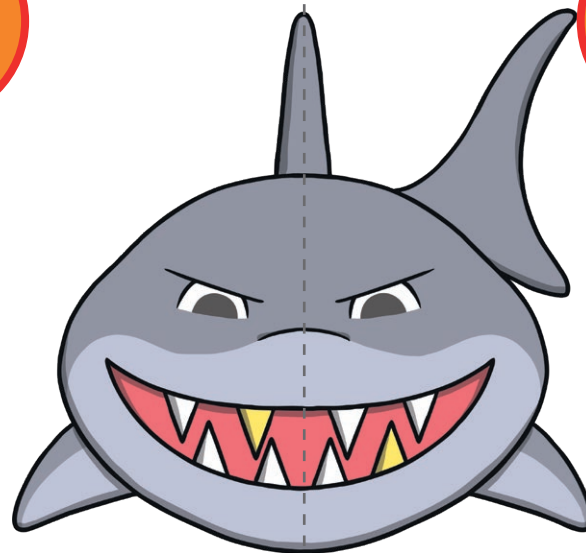
f

G



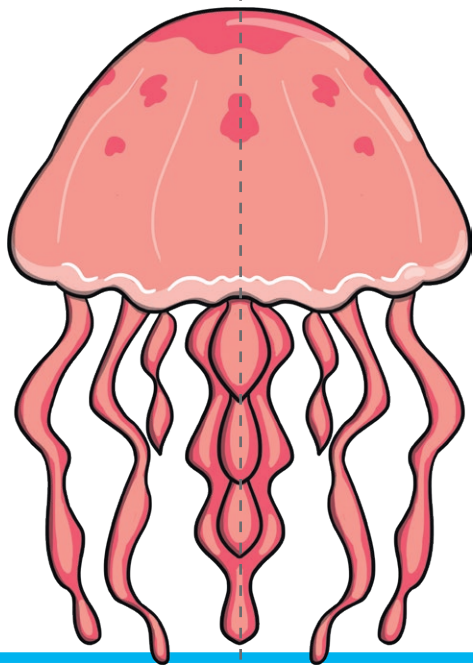
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H



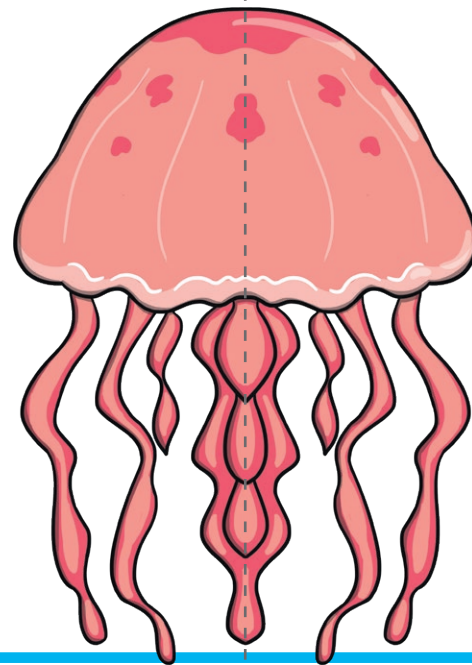
h

I



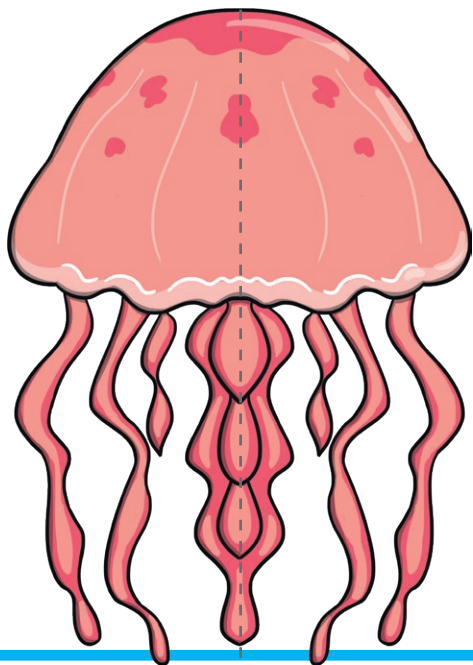
i

J



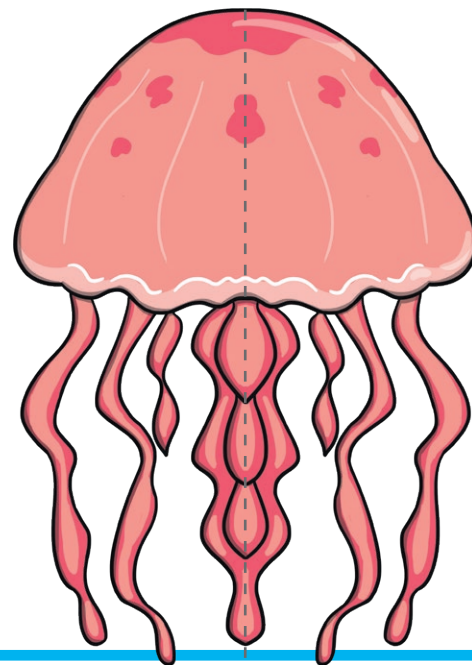
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K



k

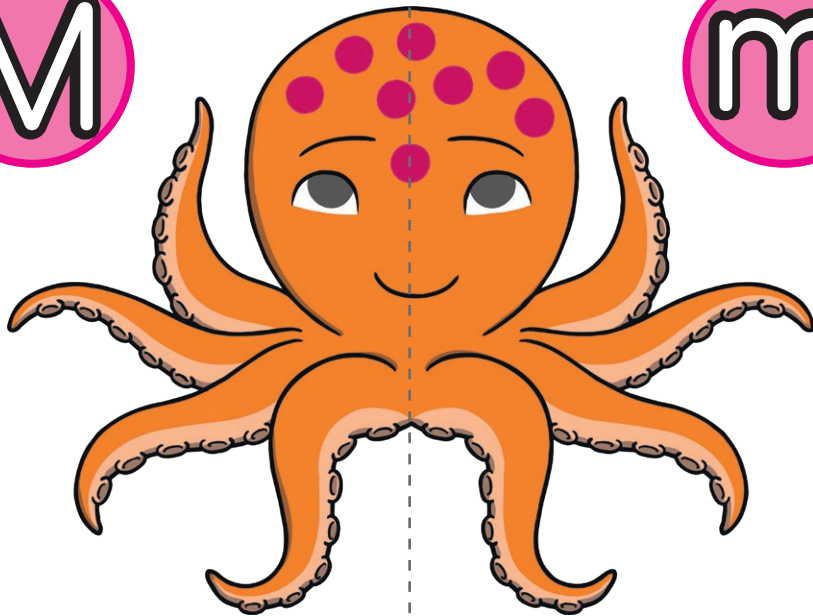
L



l

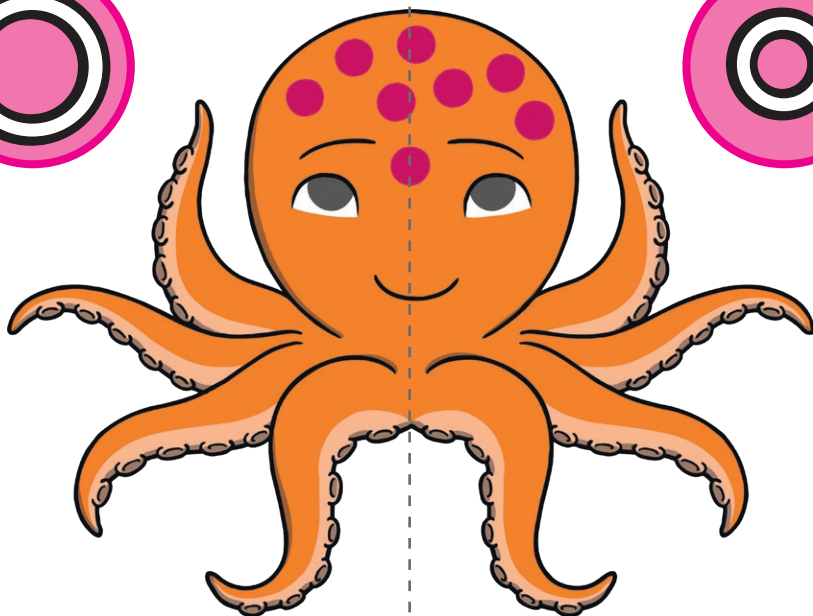
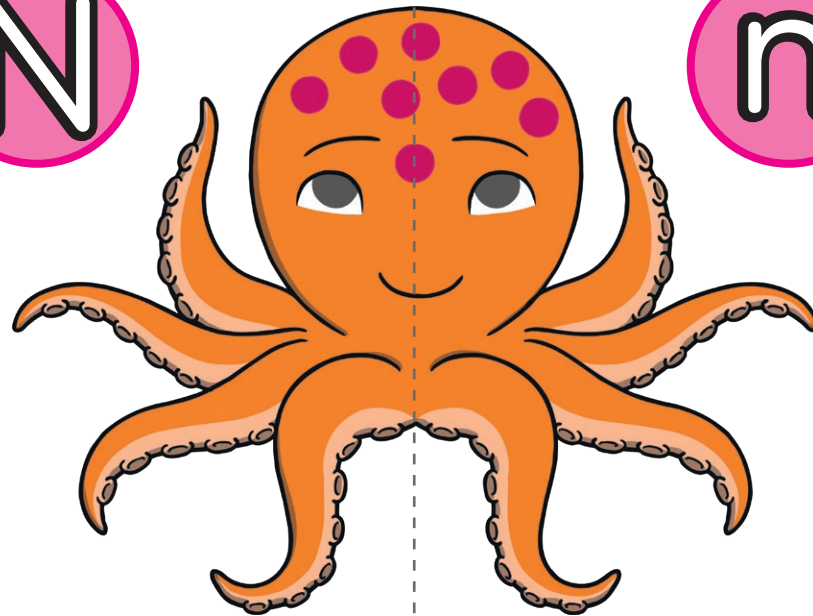
M

m



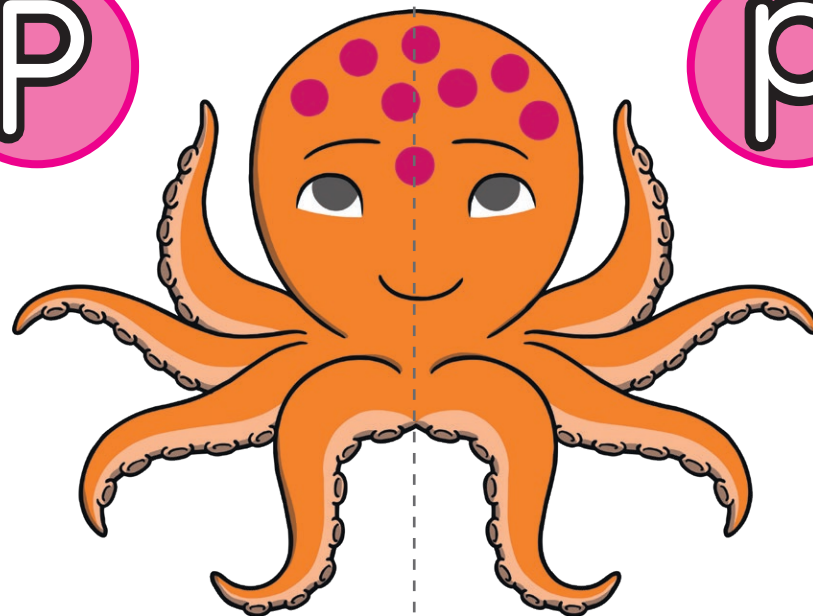
N

n



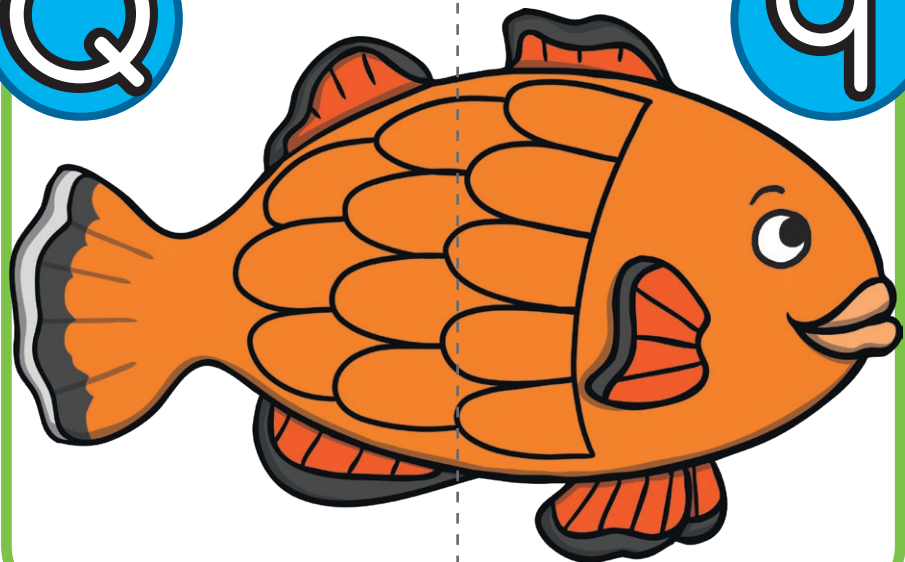
P

p



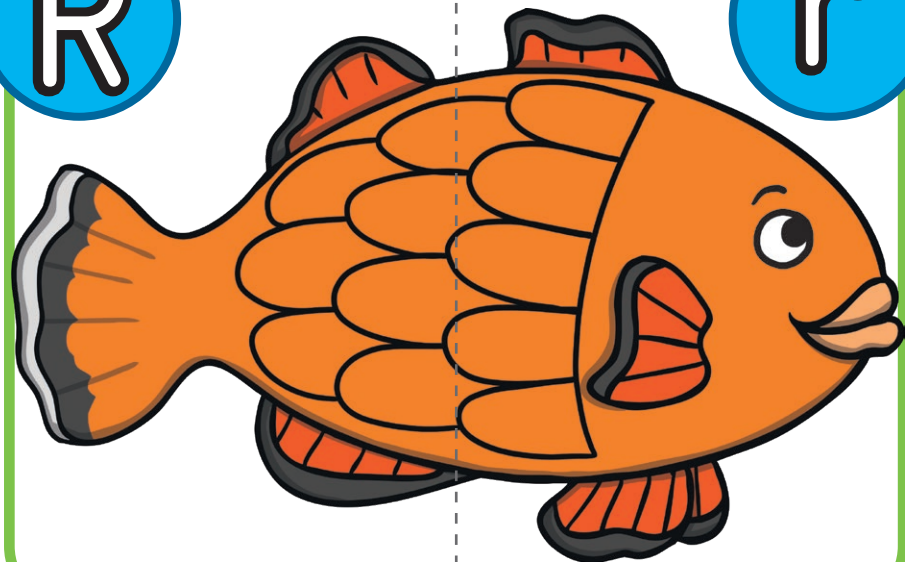
Q

q



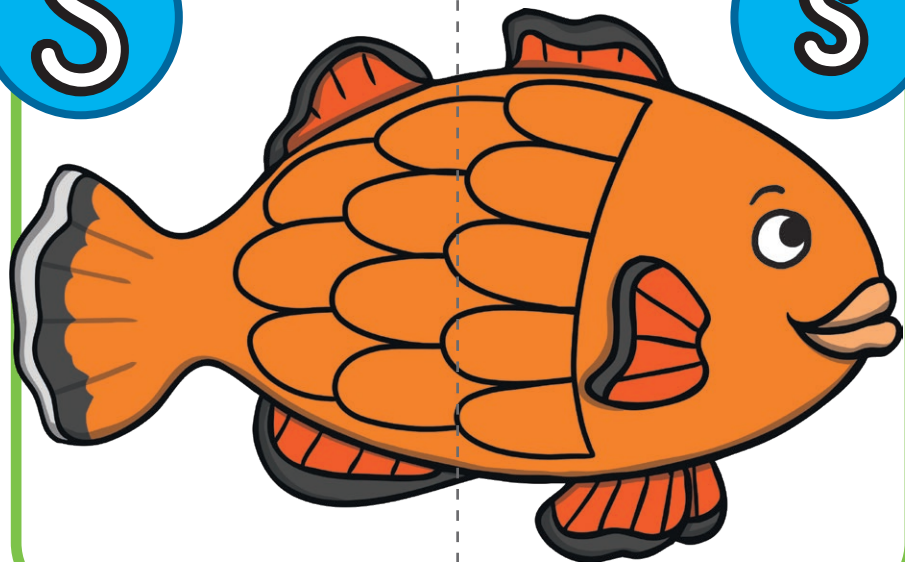
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r



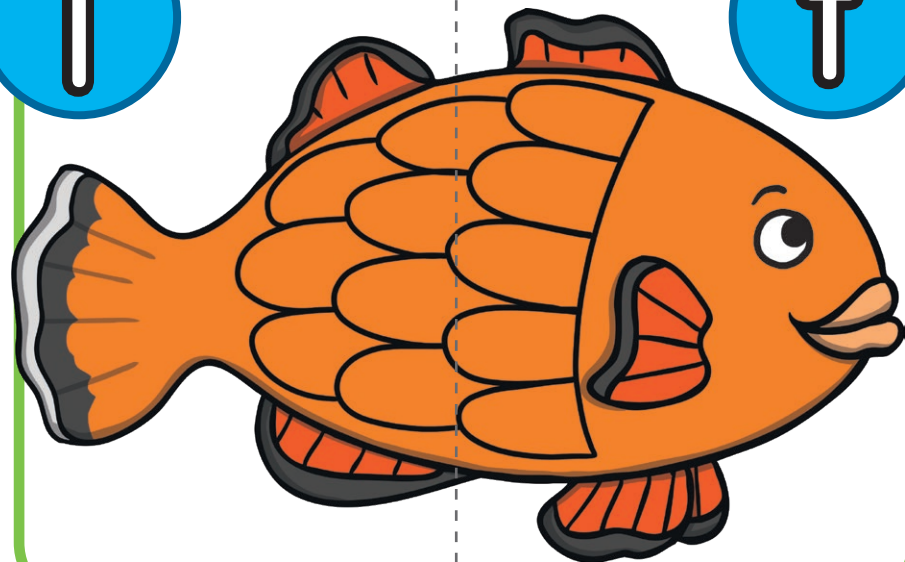
S

s



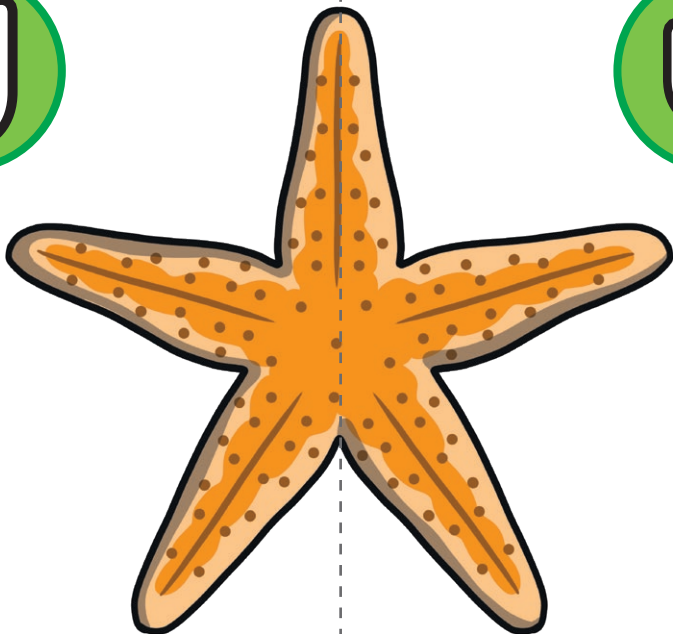
T

t



U

u

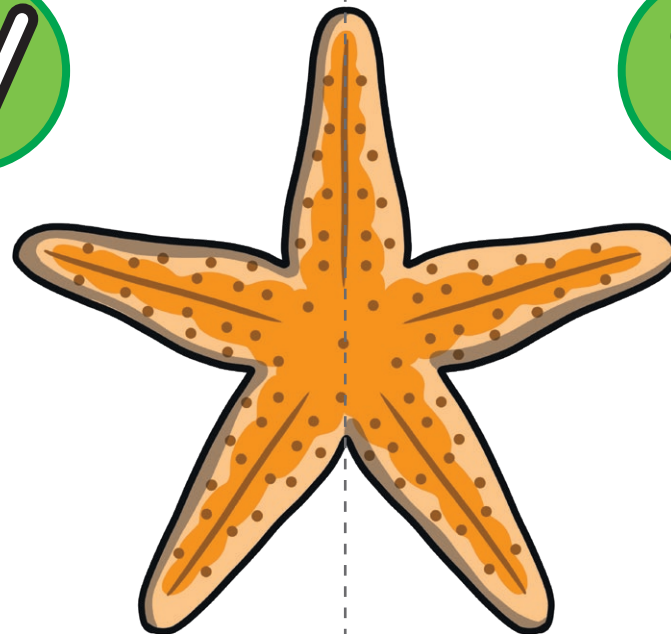


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V

v

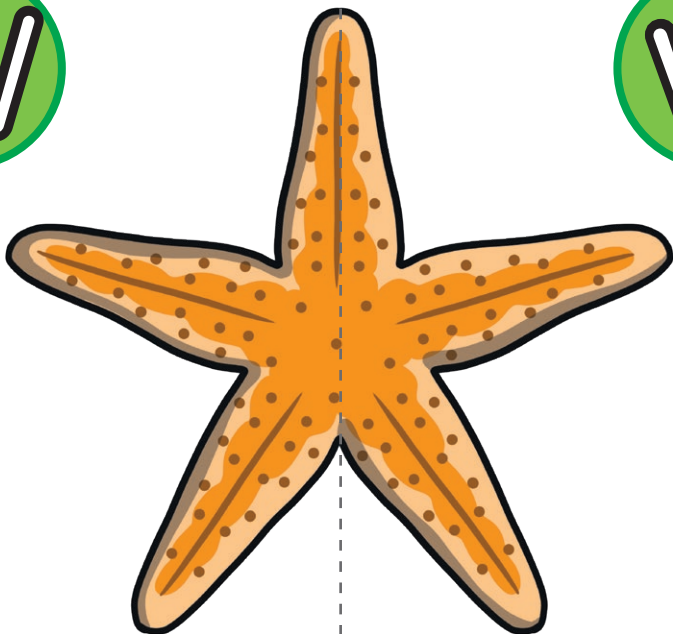


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W

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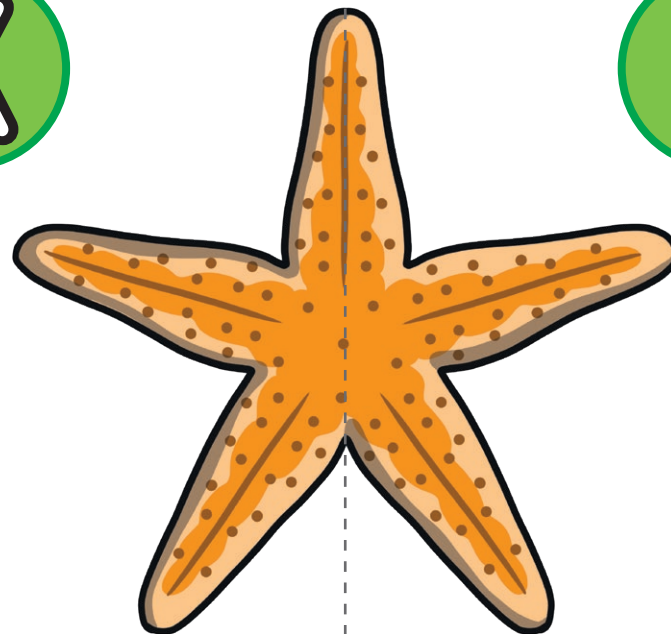


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X

x



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